

Exercise 3: Product Manager Skills and Competency Checklist

Objectives:

- Review the Car Cam Scenario
- Identify the skills required and provide justification for your assessment

Product Manager Skills, Competencies, Techniques, or Required Areas of Expertise	Definition	Skills Required	Justification if Yes
Abstract Thinking	The ability to look beyond the immediate problem or issue and envision a more wholistic view	yes	Needed to envision the broader customer experience and product ecosystem.
Analysis Skills	A general management skill. Analyze and use reliable data to make educated and focused product decisions	yes	Required to evaluate customer data and competitor metrics for informed decisions.
Analytical Skills	Know how to use the data you can access to address issues and develop solutions that ultimately lead to a successful product launch	yes	Essential for interpreting market research and performance analytics.
Analytical Thinking	Allows a Product Manager to create a sense of order, stay organized, communicate effectively across cross-functional teams, and make logical and rational decisions	yes	Enables structured decision-making during design and launch.
Attention to Detail	An organizational skill. Be able to understand specific activities that must be accomplished and organize the product team in a manner where they do things right	yes	Critical to ensure technical specifications and customer requirements are met.
Brain Writing	A technique where participants are given an opportunity to think about questions that will be asked prior to the brainstorming session. These ideas are documented on paper, sticky notes, or even electronically to be shared or discussed	yes	Helps collect team ideas efficiently before brainstorming sessions.
Brainstorming	Allows a group to share ideas and opinions in a manner that enables the generation of multiple new ideas and thoughts about a subject in a short time	yes	Encourages creative solutions for marketing and design challenges.
Business Acumen	The ability to understand and manage various business situations	yes	Needed to align pricing, ROI, and market entry strategy with business goals.
Business Skills	A general management skill. Ensure value and Return on Investment (ROI) are achieved. Manage cash flow and calculate financial metrics	yes	Required for managing budgets, costs, and product profitability.
Collaboration	A process through which a group of people constructively explore their ideas to search for a solution that extends one's own limited vision	yes	Vital for coordination between engineering, marketing, and supply chain teams.

Communications Skills	A general management skill. Regularly share ideas and convey objectives and priorities in an easy-to-understand manner	yes	Necessary for aligning stakeholders and presenting product updates clearly.
Core Benefit Identification	One of Kotler's Five Levels of a Product. Products and services that have the features or functionality to satisfy a customer's basic wants and needs	yes	Ensures the product delivers value through affordability and adaptability.
Customer Empathy Identification	The ability to put yourself in the “customer’s shoes.” Understand the customers’ needs and wants	yes	Required to understand user needs such as safety, convenience, and affordability.
Decision-Making	Ability to come to a decision quickly and begin to take action on that decision immediately. Avoid analysis paralysis	yes	Important for quick, effective choices under tight deadlines.
Delegation	An organizational skill. identify all required activities, determine who is best suited to accomplish each activity, assign realistic and clear roles and responsibilities, and control and monitor results	yes	Needed to assign responsibilities efficiently across departments.
Delphi Technique	A facilitation method where ideas and information can be gained from a panel of experts using surveys or alternative methods. In many cases, anonymity of inputs is maintained.	No	
Differentiation Analysis	Strategy to deal with Porter's Five Forces. Share how your product differs from other products. Highlight functionality or features you offer that the competition can't match	yes	Helps identify and communicate how DC Car Cam outperforms competitors.
Elevator Pitch Development	A standard six-sigma tool used to tell a product story in an accurate, brief, and concise manner. Often used to develop a Product Vision	yes	Required to craft a concise and compelling product vision for internal buy-in.
Engineering Awareness	Help develop technical solutions to enhance product effectiveness and functionality	yes	Needed to communicate effectively with engineers on camera specs and mounts.
Facilitation	Enables people to get together to achieve a common goal and directs their focus and attention in ways that serve the group itself	yes	Important to lead team meetings and keep focus on project goals.
Focus identification	Strategy to deal with Porter's Five Forces. Try to find a niche. Look for features and functionality that no competitor can provide	yes	Ensures the product focuses on features most valued by customers.
Ideation	The generation of new ideas	yes	Needed for developing innovative design and marketing ideas.

Influencing	Simply defined as motivating people to do what you need them to do.	yes	Helps gain support from executives and partners for launch initiatives.
Innovation	The execution of a new or improved product, process, marketing method, or organizational method in business practices, workplace organization, or external relations	yes	Essential for introducing unique features like multi-mount capability.
Market Segmentation Expertise	A marketing strategy that divides consumers into groups based on their needs, interests, behavior or demographics	yes	Critical to target parents of teen drivers and fleet managers effectively
Marketing Innovation Experience	One of four innovation types defined in the Oslo Manual. Innovation to achieve effective product design, packaging, promotion, and pricing	yes	Needed to design creative campaigns in a crowded market.
Marketing Skills	A general management skill. Promote and deliver products and services in the most efficient and successful ways possible	yes	Essential for positioning, promoting, and pricing the product correctly.
Messaging	The way you communicate the value of your product to customers	yes	Required to communicate the Car Cam's safety and affordability benefits clearly.
Multi-Tasking Ability	An organizational skill. Be aware of the "Two Hat Syndrome." Break out your activities, try to focus on the most critical product management related tasks, and delegate when you can.	No	
Nominal Group Technique	Ideas are discussed and annotated. Each participant then is asked to rank each idea to aid in prioritization	No	
Organizational Innovation Experience	One of four innovation types defined in the Oslo Manual. Planning and executing new methods to develop or improve an organization's business practices, workplace organization, and external relations	No	
Primary Research Ability	Going to actual or potential customers in order to gain first-hand data or information. Primary research allows you to target your actual questions to the desired segment	yes	Needed to gather customer feedback and validate assumptions.
Prioritization Skills	A general management skill. Ensure that all team members are contributing to the most important tasks and using their time appropriately	yes	Crucial to focus resources on high-value features and marketing channels.
Problem Solving	Allows a Product Manager to identify a problem, potential causes, identify root causes, and develop practical solutions	yes	Important for resolving supply chain, technical, and customer issues quickly.
Process Innovation Experience	One of four innovation types defined in the Oslo Manual. Innovation to accomplish common goals that include faster delivery, less waste, and optimizing use of resources	yes	Required to streamline production and reduce costs.

Product Innovation Experience	One of four innovation types defined in the Oslo Manual. Innovation essential when introducing a product or service with features and functionality that are new or improved	yes	Central to designing new camera capabilities and usability.
Product Management Expertise	The process of conceiving, planning, developing, testing, launching, delivering, and withdrawing products	yes	Fundamental for overseeing end-to-end product lifecycle.
Product Roadmap Development	A high-level visual summary that maps out the vision, direction, priorities, and progress of a product over time.	yes	Helps visualize milestones leading to the May 15 launch.
Radical Innovation Planning	Radical innovation proposes large changes to the existing product landscape. It aims to plan and implement large improvements by redefining the product	No	
Research Skills	A general management skill. Ensure all decisions are based on sound data and logic. Use Primary and secondary research techniques effectively	yes	Required to base decisions on reliable primary and secondary data.
Retrospective Facilitation	Inspect work that was completed, recommend changes, and adapt processes and behavior in ways to improve performance in the next Sprint	yes	Important for continuous improvement after launch.
Search Engine Optimization (SEO) Leadership	The art of making your website more visible and relevant to people who search online for products or services related to your business	yes	Helps ensure product visibility in online searches and promotions.
Secondary Research Ability	A method of collecting information that relies on indirect methods such as published reports, public or commercial databases, websites, agencies, surveys, etc.	yes	Supports competitor analysis and market trend evaluation.
Self-Motivation	An organizational skill. Set singular goals that add the most value and accomplish them one at a time. Mentally reward yourself when things go well and remain optimistic in light of challenges	yes	Necessary to maintain drive and focus in a high-pressure project.
SMART Goal Development	Goals that are specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound	yes	Ensures all objectives are specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound.
Storytelling	Helps the Product Manager create a compelling vision for their products by putting them in a larger context	yes	Useful for presenting the Car Cam's value proposition compellingly.
Strategic Thinking	A general management skill. Understand the market and decide how to launch a new product effectively	yes	Critical to plan long-term market positioning and partnerships.
Strategy	Envisioning a desired outcome, charting an efficient course to achieve this objective, and aligning to that course as long as it makes sense to do so	yes	Ensures actions align with the overall vision and business objectives.
SWOT Analysis	An analysis tool that stands for strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats. This is an appropriate tool to help guide business development objectives	yes	Helps identify strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats before launch.

Technical Expertise	A general management skill. Ensure the product meets end-user expectations regarding its function, design and user experience	yes	Necessary to understand product design constraints and ensure quality.
Time Management	An organizational skill. Work within tight deadlines set by management and customers alike. They must be able to establish realistic schedules and manage the team to achieve all key milestones and deliverable requirements	yes	Essential to meet the tight May 15 deadline.
Working Under Pressure	An organizational skill. Breakdown large projects into smaller and more understandable steps. Stay organized and focus on the most important tasks. Don't get lost in the details. Do not procrastinate and avoid dysfunctional conflict as much as possible	yes	Required to manage the fast-paced development and launch schedule.